2E Familars



ZealousChristian24

Member

Join Date: Jul 2014
Posts: 1796

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06-17-2015, 03:30 PM #31

*Originally posted by **That Other Guy***
Wait...does that mean the spirit could Claim someone and still be a familiar?

Cue the players having to stop an antagonist with a ghostly familiar from using one of their loved ones to "resurrect" said familiar, probably one of the antagonist's close loved ones.

Or, you know, you could just have them take over a cat or toad or something, but that's less fun/dangerous.

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That Other Guy

Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 702

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06-17-2015, 04:19 PM #32

*Originally posted by **ZealousChristian24***
Cue the players having to stop an antagonist with a ghostly familiar from using one of their loved ones to "resurrect" said familiar, probably one of the antagonist's close loved ones.

Or, you know, you could just have them take over a cat or toad or something, but that's less fun/dangerous.

Ok, when I run a mage 2e game I'm going to have the Ministry of the Psychopo mp use ghost-Claimed people as footsoldiers

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Seidmadr
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 822

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06-17-2015, 05:22 PM #33

*Originally posted by **That Other Guy***

Ok, when I run a mage 2e game I'm going to have the Ministry of the Psychopo mp use ghost-Claimed people as footsoldiers

Yeah, and ghost spies. They'd of course be led by a cadre of ancient mage-ghosts. Some of whom claim corpses, others spend time in the underworld or hanging around in fittingly spooky places. They'd rule through fear of impermanence and insignificance before death. Memento Mori and all that. Major disease outbreaks, war, and suchlike is the kind of thing they rally behind. When they aren't trying to get rid of each other of course. Hard to fill dead men's shoes when those shoes are filled by dead men.
Ministry of the Reaper sounds good, yes?

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That Other Guy
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 702

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06-17-2015, 05:43 PM #34

*Originally posted by **Seidmadr***

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Ministry of the Reaper sounds good, yes?*

Having the Exarch's of Death's most loyal servants be straight up Liches is really cool, and I was thinking the Ministry of the Psychopomp controls the flow of people into the Other Side through the use of death-cults (suicide cults of insanely loyal Sleepers who's ghosts are then bound into Familiars for the Seers), and they control places like the morgue and hospital, binding dying sleepers so their souls are channelled into the equivalent of a giant Soul Jar that can be used for all sorts of nasty goodness.

Servants of the Psychopomp are bastard coated bastards with a bastard filing.

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Seidmadr
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 822

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06-17-2015, 06:12 PM #35

*Originally posted by **That Other Guy***

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Servants of the Psychopomp are bastard coated bastards with a bastard filing.

Interesting. But how would that control the masses?

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That Other Guy
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 702

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06-17-2015, 06:38 PM #36

*Originally posted by **Seidmadr***

Interesting. But how would that control the masses?

It's about shacking the very souls of humanity into servitude even beyond death, forcing them to work until they are shapeless shades. It doesn't give them as much influence in the mortal world, which is why they are a Lesser Ministry, but the greater amongsst them know they have a guaranteed place in Heaven as opposed to lamenting in the underworld, which is a hell of a drug

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Freemind
Member

Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 1333

06-17-2015, 10:12 PM #37

The inverse is to spread fear of Death, which also would serve the Exarchs. Even though it is a natural process, no one wants to die, and playing up that fear can limit a population from wanting to challenge authorities or their circumstances because they are scared such actions might get them killed.

I mean, we have seen this phenomena with bank robberies and other events where the guy has a revolver with 6 rounds and takes ~30 people hostage. Theoretically, the guy couldn't kill them all and they could take him down, but no one would want to risk being the 1/6 who died. Now amplify that to a national level, and you have military dictators who remain in power because no one wants to risk dying by challenging them*. The Exarchs just do this at the level of Reality: No one challenges their power because they fear being killed off by

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these Supernal Tyrants.

(*Note: The reason you get things like the Arab Spring is usually two-fold: There is so much hatred and displeasure that people would rather be dead than deal with it, and/or they see that others have challenged the authority *and lived*, and thus the person thinks they can challenge the authority without dying either, thus overcoming their fear of dying in that circumstance)

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Eolirin
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 450

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06-17-2015, 10:46 PM #38

> *Originally posted by **Freemind***
> *(*Note: The reason you get things like the Arab Spring is usually two-fold: There is so much hatred and displeasure that people would rather be dead than deal with it, and/or they see that others have challenged the authority and lived, and thus the person thinks they can challenge the authority without dying either, thus overcoming their fear of dying in that circumstance)*

That's a little reductive isn't it? But probably a derail to get too deep into it.

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Freemind
Member

Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 1333

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06-18-2015, 12:14 AM #39

> *Originally posted by **Eolirin***
>
> *That's a little reductive isn't it? But probably a derail to get too deep into it.*

Yeah, it is a bit. Or a lot, if you want to get into the nuances.I wasn't trying to belittle courage or the nature of the Arab Spring, or make it out as being really simple (it is anything but)
I was just pointing out that for most people, it takes significant motivation for them to overcome billions of years of evolution. Most people either need to feel:

1. That death is the preferable option, and thus are willing to die if it means making life worth living
2. The inverse, which is something so wonderful that achieving it surpasses death*
3. Or you don't think that you will actually die

It is why most people who are mugged hand over the wallet, and that those who fight the mugger usually cite (if they survive) that they thought they could win without significant injury (usually young men or those trained in combat). Altruism and courage exist, for sure, and they are amazingly honorable traits.But these are still just those principles above: believing in something that you hold as worth more than your life (so dying for family is the belief that family is worth dying for).**
I only brought up the Arab Spring because it is a recent revolutionary period and I had a friend who was working in the region on a medical missionary. He told me

that many of the people he patched up cited they felt that they finally had a chance to succeed, and that they wanted a better life for their children. Freedom and Democracy were second to just making things better, and the idea that they might actually be able to despite what the government might do to them. Yes, this is a limited and anecdotal. But it was what I was thinking of when I made that post. Sorry about that.

*This can be either an afterlife, or the belief that a cause will succeed in spite of or due to your death.
** Many evolutionary behaviorist cite genetics for these. Protecting your sister saves 25% of your genes. Protecting your cousin saves 12.5%. Parents and children saves 50%. Compared to 0% if you all die, the idea of one dying to save at least some of the genes is an evolutionary advantage. Courage arose from the idea of challenging lethal obstacles for food or reproduction, and succeeding. I don't like these, as it is an interesting way to take all the humanity and passion out of noble qualities, but there yah go :/

Sorry for the thread derail.

Edit: Note, this is all different then dealing with abstract death, or facing it when you have no choice. When dealing with it as "oooh, someday I may die." like when people eat sugar despite their diabetes, this is because their brain can't recognize abstract death in the same way as "this action will get me killed." so it doesn't kick in (unfortunately, as being an MD would be easier otherwise). And when you are in a situation where you are already facing death, then the motivation is either how to face it or how to avoid it. So bravely facing death when dying of terminal cancer is very different than what I am discussing above, as is fighting back when you know you will absolutely die otherwise (99.999999999% chance of death is better than absolutely 100% chance of death).

Last edited by Freemind; 06-18-2015, 06:02 AM.

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MCN
Member

Join Date: Jan 2014
Posts: 3479

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06-18-2015, 07:09 AM #40

Can we ask what KINDS of familiars are available if we're just talking about the core book? If its a special kind of Manifestation, can we assume that we can have ghosts, spirits, and goetic familiars easily, since those three are covered in Mage core? Would an angelic familiar be viable, by any chance, do you think? Is there any potential for something along the lines of a fey sprite? Or are all those going to have to wait for new Supernal/Abyssal Summons rules?

Last edited by MCN; 06-18-2015, 07:14 AM.

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06-18-2015, 07:16 AM #41



Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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*Originally posted by **MCN***

Can we ask what KINDS of familiars are available if we're just talking about the core book? If its a special kind of Manifestation, can we assume that we can have ghosts, spirits, and goetic familiars easily, since those three are covered in Mage core? Would an angelic familiar be viable, by any chance, do you think? Is there any potential for something along the lines of a fey sprite? Or are all those going to have to wait for new Supernal/Abyssal Summons rules?

Ooo... Those are all really cool ideas! A GM angel could make a very neat thematic/visual contrast.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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06-18-2015, 07:21 AM #42



Freemind
Member

Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 1333

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*Originally posted by **Second Chances***

Ooo... Those are all really cool ideas! A GM angel could make a very neat thematic/visual contrast.

I think Dave has gone on record as saying that short of Archmastery, you can't make a GM angel do anything against their "program" or make them disobey the GM. Otherwise you would be creating another Splat (Demons).

So I don't think GM Angel Familiars are going to be an option :/

Last edited by Freemind; 06-18-2015, 07:42 AM.

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06-18-2015, 07:40 AM #43



Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014

*Originally posted by **Freemind***

Though I think Dave has gone on record as saying that short of Archmastery, you can't make a GM angel do anything against their "program" or make them disobey the GM. Otherwise you would be creating another Splat (Demons).

So I don't think GM Angel Familiars are going to be an option :/

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What if its directive was to help "guide" a particular mage? That wouldn't be going against its programming, in fact accepting the manifestation spell would likely be helping it fulfill its programming. A mage with an angel as a familiar would be a very scary thing, since it means the God Machine has a purpose for that Mage. Not that the Mage has to know that.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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ZealousChristian24

Member

06-18-2015, 07:41 AM #44

> *Originally posted by **Freemind***
>
> *Though I think Dave has gone on record as saying that short of Archmastery, you can't make a GM angel do anything against their "program" or make them disobey the GM. Otherwise you would be creating another Splat (Demons).*
>
> *So I don't think GM Angel Familiars are going to be an option :/*

Well, that just means that It just *wanted* that servitor unit to bond with you. Of course, that's not exactly the most *reassuring* option...

Join Date: Jul 2014
Posts: 1796

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Freemind

Member

06-18-2015, 07:55 AM #45

> *Originally posted by **ZealousChristian24***
> *Well, that just means that It just wanted that servitor unit to bond with you. Of course, that's not exactly the most reassuring option...*

Oh god, I didn't think of that! The ST in me is cackling for when a player in my group inevitably asks if he can have a GM angel familiar. I can't wait to say "Sure, why not? Muahahahahaha...what?" 😈

Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 1333

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